

companies.²³ Companies currently supporting the project include Airbus, American Express, Daimler, IBM, and SAP.

The project states, “Hyperledger members and staff are committed to sharing best-practices and providing assistance with the use-case development, Proof-of-Concept (POC) testing, and adoption of Hyperledger.”²⁴ Initial efforts undertaken by the group are in the finance and healthcare industries, with plans to build supply chain solutions as well. It will be interesting to see how this cross-industry collaborative and open source effort proceeds and what results come of it. An innovative investor will do well to follow the group’s efforts to help identify specific companies that may benefit from the results.

One of the more interesting recent consortiums was the Enterprise Ethereum Alliance. It went public in late February 2017, and its founding members include Accenture, BNY Mellon, CME Group, JPMorgan, Microsoft, Thomson Reuters, and UBS.²⁵ What is most interesting about this alliance is that it aims to marry private industry and Ethereum’s public blockchain. While the consortium will work on software outside of Ethereum’s public blockchain, the intent is for all software to remain interoperable in case companies want to utilize Ethereum’s open network in the future.

Create an Innovation Lab and Leave It Alone

The third strategy that an incumbent can follow is known as an *innovation lab*. Several universities, including Harvard, have set up innovation labs as a way to foster innovation through a